

GULLAK

Smart Money Management for Every Indian Family

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Version 1.0 | Confidential

Document Status	Draft - For Review
Product	Gullak Mobile App
Platform	Android (primary), iOS (future)
Target Market	Rural & Semi-Urban India
Prototype	rural-wealth-builder-app.lovable.app
Last Updated	June 2025

1. Executive Summary

Gullak is a mobile-first financial planning application built specifically for rural, semi-urban, and low-income families in India. Named after the iconic clay piggy bank found in millions of Indian homes, Gullak makes budgeting, expense tracking, savings planning, and financial literacy accessible to first-time digital users.

India has over 300 million households that lack structured financial planning tools. Existing personal finance apps are designed for urban, English-literate, salaried users, leaving an enormous underserved segment without suitable solutions. Gullak bridges this gap with a culturally resonant, regionally localised, and intentionally simple product.

This document defines the full product requirements for Gullak v1.0, covering user personas, feature specifications, UX principles, technical architecture, business model, and success metrics.

2. Problem Statement

2.1 The Financial Inclusion Gap

Despite the rapid spread of smartphones and UPI payments across India, financial planning remains largely inaccessible to rural and semi-urban populations:

- No structured budgeting: Over 80% of rural households do not maintain monthly budgets, leading to poor resource allocation.
- Irregular income: Daily wage earners, farmers, and seasonal workers have unpredictable cash flows that standard apps cannot handle.
- Lack of savings discipline: Without a structured mechanism, families cannot build emergency funds or save for planned expenses.
- Financial emergencies: Without a safety net, a single health or agricultural crisis can push a family into debt.
- Complexity of existing tools: Apps like Walnut, Money Manager, and ET Money are designed for urban, financially-literate users and feel alienating to this segment.
- Low financial literacy: Many users do not understand concepts like budgeting, compound interest, insurance, or emergency funds.

2.2 Market Opportunity

India had over 750 million internet users in 2024, with significant growth coming from rural areas. UPI transactions in rural India crossed 2 billion per quarter. Yet financial planning tools have not kept pace. There is a clear white space for a product that speaks the language — literally and culturally — of this segment.

3. Goals & Objectives

3.1 Product Goals

1. Enable any Indian family to track expenses and build savings habits within 5 minutes of onboarding, regardless of income regularity or digital literacy.
2. Make financial planning feel familiar through cultural relevance: the Gullak metaphor, Indian festivals, and agricultural cycles.
3. Provide actionable savings insights without requiring financial literacy prerequisites.
4. Build a scalable freemium business with a clear path to profitability through financial product partnerships.

3.2 Version 1.0 Scope

In Scope

- Daily expense and income tracking
- Category-based monthly budgeting
- Goal-based savings (Gullak feature)
- Spending insights and visualisations
- Hindi and Marathi language support
- Micro-learning financial education modules
- Freemium access model

Out of Scope

- Banking or UPI payment integrations
- Insurance or microfinance product marketplace
- Group / SHG collaborative features
- iOS app (planned v1.5)
- SMS-based fallback for feature phone users

4. Target Users & Personas

4.1 Primary Personas

Persona 1: Ramesh — Daily Wage Labourer

Age	32
Location	Nashik District, Maharashtra
Income	Rs. 350-500/day, irregular
Education	Class 8 pass
Device	Android smartphone (2GB RAM), Jio SIM
Language	Marathi

Goal	Save Rs. 20,000 for daughter's school admission
Pain Points	Income not fixed, forgets to save before spending, no idea where money goes

Persona 2: Savita — Farm Household Manager

Age	40
Location	Vidarbha, Maharashtra
Income	Seasonal farm income + Rs. 3,000/month ASHA worker stipend
Education	Class 10 pass
Device	Shared Android phone in household
Language	Marathi, Hindi
Goal	Track household expenses, save for son's coaching fees
Pain Points	Seasonal income swings, feels excluded from financial decisions

Persona 3: Suresh — Small Kirana Shop Owner

Age	45
Location	Tier-3 town, Uttar Pradesh
Income	Rs. 25,000-40,000/month (variable)
Education	Class 12 pass
Device	Android; uses WhatsApp and UPI daily
Language	Hindi
Goal	Separate business and household finances, save for shop renovation
Pain Points	Mixes personal and business money, borrows for festivals

4.2 Secondary Personas

- Women's Self-Help Group (SHG) leaders managing group savings
- Students aged 18-24 in semi-urban colleges learning money management
- First-time smartphone users transitioning from feature phones

5. User Journeys

5.1 Onboarding Journey

5. User downloads Gullak from Play Store (vernacular app listing).
6. Language selection screen: Hindi / Marathi / English (default: device language).

- 7. 3-step profile setup: name, income type (daily/weekly/monthly/seasonal), household size.
- 8. First income entry prompt: 'Aaj kitna kamaya?' (How much did you earn today?).
- 9. Home dashboard with visual Gullak piggy bank that fills as savings grow.

5.2 Daily Expense Tracking Journey

- 10. User opens app via home screen widget shortcut.
- 11. Taps large '+' button: 'Kharcha Daalo' (Add Expense).
- 12. Selects category via icon grid — no text required.
- 13. Enters amount via numeric keypad; optional voice input.
- 14. Optional: add voice note or photo of receipt.
- 15. Confirmation screen shows running daily total and budget remaining.

5.3 Goal Savings Journey

- 16. User taps 'Gullak' tab.
- 17. Creates new goal: selects from templates or sets a custom goal.
- 18. Enters target amount and target date.
- 19. App suggests daily/weekly savings amount needed.
- 20. User marks savings contributions; piggy bank animates to show progress.
- 21. Weekly push notification: 'Aapne is hafte Rs. X bachaye. Rs. Y aur baaki hai!'

6. Feature Specifications

6.1 Expense Tracking

The core daily interaction, designed to take under 15 seconds per entry. Accessibility and simplicity are the primary design constraints.

Expense Categories

Category	Icon	Sub-categories
Food & Groceries	:cart:	Ration, vegetables, milk, eating out
Travel	:bus:	Auto, bus, fuel, train
Education	:books:	School fees, books, tuition, stationery
Healthcare	:pill:	Doctor, medicines, hospital
Utilities	:bulb:	Electricity, water, mobile recharge
Farming	:sheaf:	Seeds, fertiliser, labour, equipment
Festivals & Occasions	:diya:	Diwali, Eid, weddings, puja

Category	Icon	Sub-categories
Home	:house:	Rent, repairs, household items
Other	:box:	Miscellaneous

Acceptance Criteria

- User can log an expense in under 4 taps / 15 seconds.
- Category icons are visual-first; text labels are optional (supports low-literacy users).
- Voice input supported for amount entry in Hindi and Marathi.
- Offline-first: expenses logged without internet; sync when connection restored.
- Duplicate entry prevention: warn if same amount + category logged within 2 minutes.

6.2 Income Tracking

Handles the irregular income patterns unique to the target segment. The app must never assume regular monthly income.

Income Types Supported

- Daily wages (log each earning day)
- Weekly earnings
- Monthly salary or stipend
- Seasonal or one-time (harvest sale, bonus, remittance)
- Multiple simultaneous income sources

Acceptance Criteria

- Users can log income from multiple sources independently.
- Income calendar view shows high-income vs low-income months visually.
- No income entry required every day; app adapts to the user's logging frequency.

6.3 Monthly Budget Planning

A guided planning tool based on the user's actual income history and household type — not a blank form.

Budget Features

- Auto-suggested budget based on past 3-month spending patterns.
- Manual category-level budget caps (e.g., Food: Rs. 5,000/month).
- Visual progress bar per category; turns red when approaching limit.
- Festival mode: auto-increases relevant category budgets during festival months.
- 'Kharcha Kitna Bacha?' — single-tap summary of remaining budget.

Acceptance Criteria

- Budget creation guided by wizard, not a blank spreadsheet.
- App notifies user when a category reaches 80% of its budget.
- Irregular income users can set a 'base budget' and a 'bonus month' budget.

6.4 Goal-Based Savings (Gullak)

The hero feature. Users create savings goals and track progress via an animated piggy bank (gullak) that visually fills as contributions are made.

Goal Templates

Goal Template	Target Range	Icon
School / College Fees	Rs. 5,000 - Rs. 50,000	Books
Medical Emergency Fund	Rs. 10,000 - Rs. 1,00,000	Hospital
Festival Expenses	Rs. 2,000 - Rs. 20,000	Diya
Mobile Phone	Rs. 5,000 - Rs. 25,000	Phone
Farm Equipment / Inputs	Rs. 10,000 - Rs. 2,00,000	Tractor
Home Repair	Rs. 10,000 - Rs. 5,00,000	House
Custom Goal	User-defined	Star

Acceptance Criteria

- Free tier: up to 3 simultaneous goals. Premium: unlimited goals.
- App calculates daily/weekly savings needed to reach the goal by the target date.
- Progress visualised as animated gullak filling up — no literacy required to understand.
- 'Break the gullak' (withdrawal) requires a friction confirmation screen to discourage impulse withdrawals.
- Goal completion triggers confetti animation and a WhatsApp-shareable achievement card.

6.5 Savings Insights

Simple, visual analytics designed for non-financially literate users. No jargon. All insights in plain language at a Class 5 reading level.

Insight Types

- Spending breakdown: pie chart by category (past 30 days).
- Income vs Expense trend: bar chart, monthly view.
- Savings rate: 'Is mahine aapne apni kamayi ka X% bachaya. Bahut achha!'
- Category alerts: 'Pichle mahine tyoharon par Rs. 3,200 kharch huye — aam se 40% zyada.'
- Smart suggestions: 'Mobile recharge par Rs. 100/month bachane se school fees 2 hafte pehle puri ho sakti hai.'

Acceptance Criteria

- All charts accessible to color-blind users (pattern + color + label).
- Zero financial jargon (no 'net worth', 'cash flow', 'ROI').
- Insights refresh weekly to give users a reason to return.

6.6 Local Language Support

Full app localisation — not just translation. Cultural context and idioms must be accurate.

Language Requirements

- v1.0: Hindi, Marathi, English.
- v1.1 planned: Tamil, Telugu, Gujarati, Kannada, Bengali, Odia.
- Voice input for amount entry in Hindi and Marathi.
- All notifications, insights, and tips in the user's selected language.
- Currency always displayed as Rs. with Indian formatting (lakhs, crores).

Acceptance Criteria

- Zero English strings visible to a Hindi-only user.
- Language switchable at any time from Settings without data loss.
- All financial education modules fully translated, not just UI strings.

6.7 Financial Education: Gyaan ki Gullak

Short micro-learning modules (2-3 minutes each) in vernacular language. Named 'Gyaan ki Gullak' (Piggy Bank of Knowledge).

v1.0 Module Topics

Module	Key Message	Format
Why Save?	Small daily savings grow into large amounts over time	Animated story
Emergency Fund Basics	Keep 3 months of expenses saved separately	Infographic + quiz
Smart Budgeting	Allocate income before spending it	Interactive calculator
Responsible Borrowing	Borrow only what you can repay in 3 months	Story-based scenario
Avoiding Money Traps	Chit funds, lottery, easy loan apps: red flags	Quiz
Banking Basics	What is a savings account, FD, RD?	Animated explainer

Acceptance Criteria

- Each module completable in under 3 minutes.
- Modules use stories featuring relatable Indian characters (Ramesh, Savita).
- Completion earns a badge displayed in the user's profile.
- Modules available offline after first download.

7. UX & Design Principles

7.1 Core Design Principles

Priority	Principle	Description	Example
1	Visual First	Communicate through icons, colour, and animation before text	Category selection via icon grid
2	4-Tap Rule	Any core action completable in 4 taps or fewer	Expense logging in under 15 seconds
3	Culturally Familiar	Use Indian metaphors, colours (saffron, green), and contexts	Gullak as progress indicator
4	Forgiving	Easy to correct mistakes; no destructive actions without confirmation	Edit or delete any entry anytime
5	Celebratory	Celebrate small wins to reinforce savings habits	Confetti on milestone reached

7.2 Accessibility Requirements

- Minimum tap target size: 48x48 dp (WCAG 2.1 AA compliance).
- Minimum body font size: 16sp; no visible text below 12sp.
- Contrast ratio: 4.5:1 minimum for all text elements.
- TalkBack / Voice-over compatibility for visually impaired users.
- Low-bandwidth mode: app functional on a 2G connection; assets lazy-loaded.
- Maximum app install size: 25 MB; supports devices with 1.5 GB RAM.

7.3 Onboarding UX

- No mandatory sign-up to try the app. Guest mode available for 7 days.
- Progressive onboarding: ask for information only when needed.
- All tutorials skip-able; accessible from Help at any time.
- First run: 30-second animated explainer of Gullak's core value.

8. Technical Requirements

8.1 Platform & Device Support

Requirement	Specification
Primary Platform	Android (Google Play Store)
Minimum Android Version	Android 8.0 (Oreo, API 26)
Target Android Version	Android 14 (API 34)
Minimum RAM	1.5 GB
Maximum App Size	25 MB (install) / 50 MB (with cached education content)

Requirement	Specification
Connectivity	Offline-first; background sync when connection available
iOS	Planned for v1.5 (post product-market fit validation)

8.2 Data & Security

- All user financial data encrypted at rest (AES-256).
- All data transmitted over HTTPS / TLS 1.3.
- Biometric or PIN app lock option.
- No financial data shared with third parties without explicit user consent.
- DPDP Act 2023 (India) compliant data handling.
- Optional Google Drive backup: user-controlled.
- Account deletion: all data permanently purged within 30 days of request.

8.3 Performance Requirements

- App cold start: under 2 seconds on a mid-range Android device.
- Expense logging screen load: under 500 ms.
- Insights dashboard load: under 1.5 seconds (with cached data).
- Crash-free session rate: above 99.5%.
- ANR (App Not Responding) rate: below 0.1%.

8.4 Offline-First Architecture

Given the low-connectivity environments of target users, Gullak must be fully functional without internet:

- All expense and income logging works fully offline.
- Budget calculations and goal progress computed locally on-device.
- Financial education modules cached on first download.
- Data syncs automatically when connectivity is restored.
- Conflict resolution for sync: last-write-wins for single-user accounts.

9. Business Model

9.1 Freemium Tier Comparison

Feature	Free Tier	Premium (Rs. 49/month)
Expense & Income Tracking	Unlimited	Unlimited
Active Savings Goals	Up to 3	Unlimited
Budget Categories	8 default categories	Custom categories + sub-categories

Feature	Free Tier	Premium (Rs. 49/month)
Reports & Insights	Last 30 days	Last 12 months + PDF export
Financial Education Modules	4 modules	All modules + new releases
Family Accounts (sub-users)	Not included	Up to 5 family members
Goal Recommendations	Basic	AI-powered personalised recommendations
Financial Coaching	Not included	Monthly session with advisor
In-App Ads	Yes (non-intrusive)	None

9.2 Future Revenue Streams (Post v1.0)

- Banking partnerships: referral fees for opening savings accounts.
- Microfinance: commission on microloans facilitated through partner NBFCs.
- Micro-insurance: commission on Pradhan Mantri Bima Yojana-linked products.
- Financial product marketplace: curated RD, FD, and SIP products.
- B2B licensing: white-label version for SHGs and NGOs.

10. Success Metrics & KPIs

10.1 North Star Metric

Active Savings Goals Achieved — the number of goals fully funded and closed by users per month.

This metric captures whether Gullak delivers real financial value, not just engagement.

10.2 Supporting KPIs

Metric	Month 6 Target	Month 12 Target
Monthly Active Users (MAU)	50,000	2,00,000
Day-7 Retention	40%	50%
Day-30 Retention	20%	30%
Avg. Expenses Logged / User / Month	15	25
Users with Active Savings Goal (%)	60%	70%
Goal Completion Rate	20%	35%
Free-to-Premium Conversion Rate	3%	6%
Education Module Completion Rate	30%	50%
Crash-Free Session Rate	99.5%+	99.5%+

Metric	Month 6 Target	Month 12 Target
Net Promoter Score (NPS)	45+	55+

11. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Low digital literacy causes high drop-off at onboarding	High	High	Voice-guided onboarding, video tutorials, 30-sec explainer, community agent network
Users distrust app with sensitive financial data	High	High	No bank linking in v1.0; 'data stays on your phone' messaging; biometric lock
Irregular income makes budget features irrelevant	Medium	High	Flexible income types; seasonal budget wizard; skip-budget option available
Android fragmentation causes crashes on low-end devices	Medium	High	Minimum API 26; QA on top 20 Indian device models
Low premium conversion rate	Medium	Medium	Validate premium value props via beta user interviews; test Rs. 29 price point
Competitor replication by large fintech players	Low	High	Build brand loyalty, vernacular depth, and community features that are hard to copy quickly

12. Product Roadmap

Version	Timeline	Key Deliverables
v0.1 - Internal Alpha	Month 1-2	Core expense + income tracking, Hindi UI, local SQLite storage, no backend
v0.5 - Closed Beta	Month 3-4	Goal-based savings, basic insights, Marathi support, 500 beta users in Maharashtra
v1.0 - Public Launch	Month 5-6	Full feature set, Play Store launch, freemium model, push notifications, education modules
v1.1 - Language Expansion	Month 7-8	Tamil, Telugu, Gujarati, Kannada; improved voice input accuracy
v1.2 - Community Features	Month 9-10	SHG / family group accounts, shared goals, peer savings challenges
v1.5 - Monetisation	Month 11-12	Banking referral integrations, micro-insurance, iOS beta
v2.0 - Platform	Year 2	AI-powered savings coach, financial marketplace, B2B NGO licensing

13. Open Questions & Decisions Needed

#	Question	Owner	Due
1	Should v1.0 require phone number sign-up or allow fully anonymous guest use?	Product	Sprint 1
2	What is the right premium price point: Rs. 29, Rs. 49, or Rs. 99/month?	Product + Growth	Beta launch
3	Clay pot or coin-box gullak illustration: which resonates more with the audience?	Design	Sprint 1
4	Should v1.1 support WhatsApp-based expense logging (chatbot) as alternate entry?	Engineering	v1.1 planning
5	Which NGO/MFI partners should we approach for pilot distribution in Maharashtra and UP?	Business Dev.	Month 3
6	Should v1.2 support UPI statement import to auto-log expenses?	Engineering	v1.2 planning

14. Appendix

14.1 Glossary

Term	Definition
Gullak	Traditional Indian clay or metal piggy bank; the product name and central savings metaphor
SHG	Self-Help Group: community-based savings and credit groups, predominantly women
NBFC	Non-Banking Financial Company: regulated institutions offering loans and financial services
DPDP Act	Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023: India's data privacy legislation
Jan Dhan	Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana: India's national financial inclusion programme
MAU	Monthly Active Users
NPS	Net Promoter Score: customer loyalty and satisfaction metric (scale -100 to +100)
ANR	App Not Responding: Android error state triggered by UI thread blocking

14.2 References

- RBI Report on Financial Inclusion in India, 2023
- NSSO Household Expenditure Survey Data
- Gullak Prototype: rural-wealth-builder-app.lovable.app/savings

- PMJDY Programme Data, Ministry of Finance, Government of India
- Competitive Analysis: Walnut, Money Manager, ET Money, Spendee, Monefy

-- End of Document --